Eric Silver

linkedin.com/in/epsilver | aporia.institute
Pittsburgh, PA

EDUCATION

CARNEGIE MELLON
Doctoral Studies (ABD) 2015 - 24
Social and Decision Science
Coursework and comprehensive exams completed; dissertation not completed

MS, Behavioral Decision Research 2018

MBA, Tepper 2007
Merit scholar. Editor-in-Chief, school newspaper

UC, LOS ANGELES 1999
BA Economics

RESEARCH

• "An Event-Dated Corpus of US Trademark Prosecution," SSRN, 2026; under review
• "Communicating a Prognosis," J Gen Intern Med (2019), first author
• Co-developed (with Goldstein and Kamlet) a model that predicts 84% of the variation in average pay across US occupations from O*NET job-content ratings (held-out fit)
• Working papers on automation and on disability waiver triage

BOOKS

• *The Marriage Contract, 2027* (2026)
• *Health: A User's Guide* (2026)
• *From Sky to Sea* (2023)

TOOLS

• Python, SQL, R, Excel
• Risk adjustment, cost-effectiveness analysis, experiments, simulation

NOTEWORTHY

• Pittsburgh's "40 Under 40", 2013
• "Pittsburgh's Best Place to Work" (as CEO), 2011-2014
• AlphaLab accelerator mentor, 2011-2018
• Angel investor: RentJungle, ModCloth, NoWait, Shoefitr; boards of Shoefitr, Digital Dream Labs and RentJungle
• Peace Corps (Armenia, 2002-2004): taught 100+ business classes in Armenian

FOCUS

Strategy, evaluation and payment design for public health systems, at Allegheny County DHS on >$450M a year in Medicaid and county-funded behavioral-health services. Former McKinsey associate, startup founder-CEO and ModCloth CMO. Researcher on trademark language and on AI and labor markets; author of two plain-English guides.

EXPERIENCE

ALLEGHENY COUNTY DHS 2024 - present
Principal Analyst, Office of Analytics and Technology
Previously Senior Advisor, Behavioral Health Strategy

- Designed risk-adjusted, peer-relative scorecards for ~700 providers that show a grade only when a difference passes a confidence test
- Evaluated a >$20M, 17-organization treatment program for the Director on raw and risk-adjusted outcomes
- Built a cost-effectiveness framework (QALYs, social cost) comparing 12 types of opioid and alcohol treatment
- Modeled the 2025 federal Medicaid changes for leadership: provider revenue exposure, system cost, coverage loss
- Designed payment reforms: outcome-based residential rates, bundled opioid-treatment payments, a preferred-provider tier
- Showed why fixed-ratio ACT teams run chronically short-staffed and made the case for flexible staffing
- Combined client and provider research with claims trends to define the provider network the county should have
- Led the four-person Medicaid analytics team for about a year: set priorities; reviewed analyses and dashboards for program leaders

WEBKITE (FORMERLY PIKIMAL) | Founder & CEO 2010 - 2015
Chairman through the 2021 sale.

- Originated the idea, built the proof of concept, and raised $4M+
- Found the business model: software that wrote ad text for large Google Ads accounts and kept what tested best; reached ~$1M a year in revenue, profitably
- Managed the whole team, including the other executives; hired 40 people over five years (peak team of about 25)
- Hired a successor CEO; sold the platform and part of the team to a customer (2021)
- First inventor on three patent applications in quantitative preference modeling

MODCLOTH | Chief Marketing Officer 2009 - 2010
Used statistics and experiments to improve margins while sales grew 400%+ a year

UNIVERSITY OF PITTSBURGH | Adjunct Faculty 2015 - 2020
Built and taught an MBA course in applied behavioral economics; supervised student consulting teams. Entrepreneur in Residence.

MCKINSEY & COMPANY | Associate 2007 - 2009

- Designed a coalition negotiation aligning competing hospital systems to bargain jointly with suppliers
- Showed a multinational's distribution strategy was infeasible, leading to the closure of its direct distribution sites
- Led a seven-person team to $35M in annual savings in component manufacturing